

BNS Warehouse System

User Guide

A complete walkthrough of every screen in the system - Sales, CRM, Warehouse, the handheld scanner app, Reports and Admin - written for day-to-day use by BNS Distribution staff.

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This is a first working draft, built to show the shape and structure of the guide. Screenshot placeholders are marked throughout - once you're happy with the structure, real screenshots can be captured and dropped in, and this document will keep growing as new features (like Support Tickets, just added) settle in.

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1. Sales

The Sales section is where orders are created, tracked through to despatch, and where B2B customer accounts are managed.

1.1 Sales Activity

Route: Sales → Sales Activity. This is the master order list and the screen most people will have open most of the day.

- A single search box filters across order number, customer name, PO reference, ecommerce order number, “ordered by”, and the delivery name/town/postcode/country - type anything you know about the order and it narrows the list.
- **Status** and **Order Type** dropdowns filter further (e.g. show only On Hold orders, or only Quotes).
- Columns: Order ID, Order Number, Order Date, Company, PO Number, Ecommerce #, Ordered By, delivery details, Status and Order Type. Click the Order ID or Order Date headers to sort.
- Each row is colour-tinted by status - the colours themselves are configurable per person under Settings → Customisation, so everyone can use whatever scheme makes sense to them.
- The list refreshes automatically every 15 seconds, so if someone despatches an order from the handheld scanner, its status updates here without you needing to reload the page.
- Click a row once to see its line items in the pane below; double-click it (or use New Order) to open the full order screen.

[SCREENSHOT PLACEHOLDER — Sales Activity list view, with a few orders visible and the line-items pane open below]

1.2 Order Edit

Route: opened from Sales Activity, or Sales → Sales Activity → New Order. This is the busiest screen in the system, so it's broken down panel by panel below.

Order header

Order Number (leave blank and one is generated for you), Order Date, Customer Name/Email, the linked Company (for B2B credit accounts), Order Reference (the customer's own PO number), Ecommerce Order Number, Ordered By, the full delivery address, Status, Order Type, and a free-text Special Instructions box that prints on the picking note for the warehouse team to see.

Linked support ticket

If a support ticket has been raised about this order, a pill near the top links straight to it. If not, a “+ Open a support ticket for this order” link starts a new one with the order (and its company) already filled in - see Section 2.1.

Credit status banner

For an order linked to a Company with a credit limit set, a banner shows that company's credit used, limit and available balance (in red if over the limit), plus this specific order's own outstanding amount.

Despatch panel

What's shown here changes depending on the order's status:

- **While On Hold:** set a Shipping Cost and choose a courier and service. Today only DPD is wired up - the Service list is fetched live from DPD for this order's real delivery postcode and weight (shown as "Live"), falling back to the last list that worked ("Cached") or to free-text entry if DPD can't be reached at all. **Release for Despatch** sends the order into the warehouse picking queue. If the linked company is over its credit limit, release is blocked until a typed override reason is given and "Release Anyway" is clicked - this override is logged.
- **Once released:** Print Picking Note and Send Acknowledgement buttons appear (the acknowledgement is an email to the customer confirming their order; Settings can turn both of these on automatically at release). A "View composed email" toggle shows exactly what was sent.
- **Completed / Partially Despatched orders:** Reverse to Despatch undoes just the despatch step (useful for a quick address or quantity fix without redoing picking/packing); Cancel & Return to Stock fully unwinds picking, packing and despatch, returning every item to its original bin.
- **DPD shipment:** once booked, the consignment and parcel numbers are shown with a Print Label button (sends straight to the configured Zebra printer via the local print agent); if not yet booked, a Book DPD Shipment button appears.

Payments

A table of payments already recorded (date, amount, reference, notes) plus a simple form to record a new one. Recording a payment updates the credit-status banner immediately.

Order lines

An editable grid - search for a product by SKU or name, then set quantity ordered, quantity despatched, unit price and notes per line. Lines can be added or removed freely before the order is released.

Note: A floating Save/Create Order button stays fixed to the bottom-right of the screen so it's always reachable, however long the order gets. If someone else saves the same order first, you'll be prompted to reload rather than silently overwriting their changes.

[SCREENSHOT PLACEHOLDER — Order Edit screen - header, despatch panel and order lines]

1.3 Companies

Route: Sales → Companies. B2B account management - each row shows the company name, credit status (used / limit / available, with a red "OVER LIMIT" flag) and EORI number where set.

- **Tickets** - expands to show every support ticket linked to this company (ticket number, title, order, status, talk time). See Section 2.1.
- **Edit** - inline form for Name, Credit Limit, Shopify Company ID, Notes, EORI Number and VAT Number (the last two feed customs paperwork on shipments to Ireland - see the DPD settings, Section 6.5).
- **Delete** - asks for confirmation, and is blocked by the system if the company still has orders or tickets linked to it (so a genuine account can't be deleted by accident; a duplicate or test/Shopify-imported company with nothing real attached deletes cleanly).

A New Company button at the top opens a simple create form (Name plus an optional Credit Limit). Linking an order to a Company here is what switches on credit checking for that order at release time.

[SCREENSHOT PLACEHOLDER — Companies list, with one row expanded to show its linked tickets]

2. CRM

The CRM section covers customer-facing interactions that sit alongside an order rather than inside one: support calls/emails, and product returns.

2.1 Support Tickets

Route: CRM → Support Tickets. Used to log any inbound call or email - not every one relates to a specific order, so a ticket can exist on its own, linked to a Company, linked to an Order, or both.

- **New Ticket** captures a title, caller name, phone, email, status (In Progress / On Hold / Closed / Complete), talk time (entered as hours + minutes), and optional links to a Company and/or an Order via a type-to-search box - linking an order automatically fills in its company too, unless one's already been chosen.
- Each ticket has a running **timeline** - free-text updates, each stamped with who added it and when, so a ticket that gets added to over several calls stays readable rather than becoming one long, unattributed block of text.
- Status can be changed at any point from the same screen as the call develops.
- Every ticket gets a sequential ticket number (TKT-10001 onward) the moment it's created.

A ticket raised about a specific order shows as a link on that order's own screen (Section 1.2), and every ticket linked to a company is visible from that company's row on the Companies page (Section 1.3).

Note: A call-transcription/CRM-import service can also open tickets automatically via the Support Tickets API - see the separate *BNS Warehouse Support Tickets API* document for integration details.

[SCREENSHOT PLACEHOLDER — Support Tickets list, and a single ticket's detail screen with its timeline]

2.2 RMAs (Returns)

Covers the full lifecycle of a product return, from the customer's own submission through to it being received back and credited.

Step 1 - Customer submission (public form)

Route: a public link (/rma) - no login required, and not part of the internal sidebar at all. The customer enters their own details (name, company, address, contact info), then adds one row per item being returned: product (searched by SKU/name), quantity, and the MAC or serial number of the actual unit. As soon as they type or scan an identifier, the form looks it up live and shows whether it matches a real order and whether it's still within the return window - shown in green when it checks out, amber when it doesn't match or can't be verified automatically ("we'll verify this by hand"). Ticking "This item is faulty" reveals a Grandstream support ticket number field and makes a full replacement delivery address mandatory, since a faulty item may need a replacement shipped straight back out. On submission the customer is given a reference number - nothing further to log in.

Step 2 - Triage

Route: CRM → RMAs. Tabs for Submitted / Approved / Received / Rejected / All. Each row shows the public reference, the internal RMA number (once one's assigned), customer, item count, submission date, and flag badges for anything Faulty or Unmatched that needs a manual look.

Step 3 - Review

Opening a Submitted RMA shows full customer/contact details, any linked orders (Original, Replacement, Credit), and a line-by-line item table with product, scanned identifier, quantity, faulty flag, matched order (or a red "Not matched - verify manually" warning), the return window's validity and expiry date, and the Grandstream ticket number if given. From here staff either **Approve** it (optionally recording who approved it, and for faulty items confirming/editing the replacement delivery address) or **Reject** it (with a reason and who rejected it).

Step 4 - Receiving

Once an Approved RMA's physical return arrives, each item is ticked off as Received; for non-faulty items there's an option to apply a 15% restocking fee. **Process Receipt & Credit** finalises the RMA. A **Print Cover Sheet** button is available once an internal RMA number exists, for attaching to the returned parcel.

[SCREENSHOT PLACEHOLDER — RMA public request form, and the internal RMA Detail review screen]

3. Warehouse

The Warehouse section covers the product catalogue, purchase orders, receiving stock, despatch/packing, and everything to do with knowing what stock exists and where it is - including the batch/serial/MAC traceability that's central to how BNS tracks its Grandstream inventory.

3.1 Products

Route: Warehouse → Products. The product catalogue. Each row shows SKU, name, default bin, a Tracking Type badge, and flags for “Needs Review” (a new product pulled in from Shopify that needs its tracking type confirmed) and “Inactive”. Expanding a row shows live stock by location - Available, Quarantined, Allocated, Despatched, Returned and Total per bin.

Tracking Type is the core concept behind this whole system - it decides how precisely an individual unit of a product is tracked:

- **NONE** - tracked only as a quantity in a bin, with no record of individual units. Right for accessories/consumables where one unit is interchangeable with the next.
- **SERIAL** - every physical unit has its own serial number, tied to the batch/carton it arrived in and its current bin and status. Used for items that need individual traceability but don't carry a network MAC address.
- **MAC** - every unit is tracked by its own MAC address (most of BNS's catalogue - Grandstream phones, gateways, routers). A WiFi MAC and default password are also recorded per unit where applicable. This is what makes it possible to answer “which MACs were in carton X” and “where did this specific device end up” - see Stock Trace, Section 3.7.

Product Detail (opened from a row) adds Description, Commodity Code (the HS code used for customs declarations), Country of Origin, and an Active toggle, alongside the same stock-by-location breakdown.

[SCREENSHOT PLACEHOLDER — Products list with the Tracking Type badges visible, and a Product Detail screen]

3.2 Purchase Orders

Route: Warehouse → Purchase Orders. The list shows PO Number, Supplier, Expected Date and a colour-coded Status (Draft / Awaiting Stock / Part Received / Received / Cancelled). A new PO is created by picking a supplier and expected date and adding lines (product + quantity ordered).

While a PO is Draft or Awaiting Stock, its detail screen offers a spreadsheet import: upload the supplier's shipment file (columns SKU, MAC, SERIAL, BATCH, WIFI_MAC) and the system checks the total per SKU matches the PO exactly before accepting anything - the whole import is rejected otherwise. A per-SKU match table and a summary (“Imported N cartons / M items - this PO is now ready for Goods In”) confirm what happened. This is the point where individual MAC/serial/batch data first enters the system for a shipment. Past Draft/Awaiting Stock, the screen simply points to Goods In to continue receiving.

[SCREENSHOT PLACEHOLDER — Purchase Order Detail screen with the spreadsheet import in progress]

3.3 Goods In

Route: Warehouse → Goods In. Session-based carton receiving. Start a session by picking an eligible PO and a destination bin, then scan or type carton barcodes one at a time into the input box - each is validated and logged immediately (a green “✓ Added” with SKU and item count, or a clear error such as a duplicate or mismatch), with a running “cartons scanned” count. **Save & Complete** books everything into the chosen bin for real; **Pause** leaves the session to be resumed later, from either the desktop or the handheld.

[SCREENSHOT PLACEHOLDER — Goods In session mid-scan, showing the scan log and running count]

3.4 Despatch & Packing

Route: Warehouse → Despatch. Lists orders that have finished handheld picking and are ready to pack, showing Order, Customer, line count, who picked it, and pick status (Fully picked / Short picked). “Pack & Ship” opens the Packing screen for that order, in whichever mode is set globally under Settings → Despatch & Packing:

- **Split Packing** - add cartons, then split each line's required quantity across them (by amount or by fixed box size), set each carton's weight, and Confirm Despatch - which consumes the stock, books and labels the DPD shipment, and prints the label. Doesn't track which specific unit went in which box.
- **Serial Packing** - the same carton/weight workflow, but individual scanned units are assigned to a specific carton one at a time, so exactly which unit is in which box is known afterwards and traceable via Stock Trace.

[SCREENSHOT PLACEHOLDER — Packing screen in Serial Packing mode, assigning scanned units to cartons]

3.5 Stock Movement

Route: Warehouse → Stock Movement. Manual relocation between bins. Scan or type a MAC, serial, or batch/carton code - a MAC-shaped value is looked up directly; anything else is tried as a serial first, then as a batch/carton (which pulls in every unit from that carton at once). Matches build up in a “Ready to move” list - identifier, SKU/product, batch, current location - each removable before committing. Pick a destination bin and click **Move N item(s)**; the result banner reports how many moved and lists anything skipped, with a reason.

[SCREENSHOT PLACEHOLDER — Stock Movement screen with a few items queued in the “Ready to move” list]

3.6 Stock Overview

Route: Warehouse → Stock Overview. A read-only browse of current stock, with two tabs:

- **By Bin** - an expandable list of every location; expand a bin to see the products in it, then expand a product to see every individual unit (MAC, Serial, WiFi MAC, Batch, Password, Status).
- **By Product** - search by SKU/name, expand a product to see its stock grouped by location, then expand a location to see the individual units the same way.

[SCREENSHOT PLACEHOLDER — Stock Overview, By Bin tab, with a bin and a product both expanded]

3.7 Stock Trace

Route: Warehouse → Stock Trace. This is the screen that directly answers the question BNS needed most from a new system: *which specific MACs/serials are in which batch or carton, and where has each one gone since*. Two search modes:

- **Single item (MAC/Serial)** - type or scan one identifier (tried as a MAC first, then a serial, or the other way round, so a format guess never produces a false “not found”). Returns a summary card (product, identifier and type, current status, current location) and a full chronological **timeline** of everything that's happened to it - received, moved (from → to), allocated/deallocated to an order, despatched, quarantined/released, returned, adjusted - each entry stamped with when, a reference/notes, and who did it.
- **Batch/Carton** - type or scan a batch/carton code to see every individual item that arrived in that carton, as a collapsible list (identifier, product, current status). Expand any one of them to see its own full timeline exactly as above.

Note: Between these two modes, Stock Trace answers both halves of BNS's original requirement in one screen: “which MACs/serials are in carton X” (Batch/Carton search), and “where did serial/MAC Y go” (Single item search, or drilling into one item from a batch result).

[SCREENSHOT PLACEHOLDER — Stock Trace - a Batch/Carton search result, with one item's timeline expanded]

3.8 Stock Import

Route: Settings → Bulk Stock Import (not in the main sidebar - this is an occasional/one-off tool, not a daily-use screen). Used to bulk-replace current on-hand stock from an OrderWise export (columns BinNumber, VariantCode, BatchNo, SerialNo, Qty). Two steps: **Preview Import** (no changes made) shows totals - rows in the file, products matched, items to be created, current items that would be removed - plus any new bins that would be created, tracking-type changes, edge-case notes worth a look, and any SKUs that didn't match a product (skipped). If there's nothing blocking, typing “REPLACE” and clicking **Confirm & Import** permanently replaces current Available/Quarantined stock with the file's contents - anything Allocated, Despatched or mid-order is left untouched. This step cannot be undone.

[SCREENSHOT PLACEHOLDER — Stock Import preview screen, showing the match summary before committing]

4. Handheld (Zebra scanner app)

The handheld app runs kiosk-style on the warehouse's Zebra scanners, as a separate full-screen, dark-themed app with no sidebar - built for scanning with gloves on, not office use. Login (/handheld/login) is separate from the desktop login, though it shares the same “recently used” quick-pick list, and includes a link to download the Android APK for setting up a new device.

4.1 Home

Three big tap targets - Picking, Goods In, Stock Movement - plus a logout button. Everything on the device flows from here.

4.2 Picking

The order list (auto-refreshing every 15 seconds) shows order number, status, customer, line count and who's currently picking it, if anyone. Opening an order starts picking automatically and shows a progress bar (one segment per line) with the current, incomplete line front and centre - SKU, product name, the default bin in large text with units available there vs. available anywhere, and a picked/ordered counter. Lines that need a scan take a MAC/serial/batch code (Enter submits); simple-quantity lines take a numeric amount with a Confirm button. **Undo Last Scan** reverses the most recent pick; **Can't Find Stock** flags a short pick and moves on. **Finish Pick** changes colour and label depending on whether every line is complete (green) or short (amber, “Finish Pick (short on stock)”).

[SCREENSHOT PLACEHOLDER — Handheld Picking screen mid-pick, showing the current line and progress bar]

4.3 Goods In

Lists any paused/open sessions to resume, or starts a new one by choosing a PO and destination bin - the same scan-cartons-into-a-log flow as the desktop Goods In screen (Section 3.3), adapted for the handheld's dark layout: a running scanned-cartons count, the scan input, a per-scan log, and Save & Complete / Pause.

4.4 Stock Movement

Mechanically identical to the desktop Stock Movement screen (Section 3.5) - scan a MAC, serial or batch, build up a pending list, pick a destination bin, and move - just styled for the handheld, and attributing every move to whichever scanner login is actually signed in on the device.

[SCREENSHOT PLACEHOLDER — Handheld Home screen and the Stock Movement screen side by side]

5. Reports

Route: Reports → Order Reports / Stock Reports / Invoice Reports. Every report here is generated live from current data as an Excel file and downloaded straight to the browser - none of them are pre-built or scheduled, so what you get always reflects the system at the moment you click the button.

Report	What it contains
Open Orders	Every order not yet completed or cancelled (On Hold, Partially Despatched, Quote awaiting conversion), o
Order Line Detail	Every order line as its own row - product, quantities, unit price and line total - for sales analysis.
Stock Levels by Location	Every product broken down by bin, with Available / Quarantined / Allocated / Despatched / Returned quan
Full Stock Item Export	Every individual unit in the system - MAC, serial, WiFi MAC, batch, bin and status.
Stock Movement History	Every recorded movement (receipts, moves, despatches) with who did it and when; optional From/To date
Invoiced Values	One row per order (invoice date, customer, company, goods/delivery/total net), filterable by date range, In

[SCREENSHOT PLACEHOLDER — Stock Reports screen with the three available report buttons]

6. Admin

Admin covers integrations, API access, error logging, and system-wide configuration.

6.1 API Access

Route: Admin → API Access. Where staff issue API keys for customers or integration partners who need to check live stock (or, from v0.092 onward, open support tickets) programmatically. Enter a Label - e.g. the customer or integration's name - and click **Generate Key**: the raw key is shown exactly once, in a copy-to-clipboard box, with a clear warning that it won't be shown again. The table below lists every key issued (label, created date, last used, Active/Revoked) with a Revoke action per active key - a revoked key stops working immediately.

Note: See the separate *BNS Warehouse Public API* and *BNS Warehouse Support Tickets API* documents for what a key issued here can actually be used for.

[SCREENSHOT PLACEHOLDER — API Access screen, showing a freshly generated key in its one-time reveal box]

6.2 Shopify Sync

Route: Admin → Shopify Sync. Manages the Shopify integration end to end - a Connect/OAuth flow if it isn't set up yet, or a status panel once it is. Manual sync actions are available separately for products, companies (B2B Shopify Companies), orders, and pushing current stock levels back to Shopify. Any new product pulled in from Shopify lands on the Products screen flagged "Needs Review" until someone confirms its Tracking Type (Section 3.1).

[SCREENSHOT PLACEHOLDER — Shopify Sync screen, connected state, with the manual sync buttons visible]

6.3 Bug Reports

Route: Admin → Bug Reports. Every failed request anywhere in the app is logged here automatically - timestamp, status/error code, what was being attempted, and context - tagged AUTO. Staff can also file one manually (a description and optional error code), tagged MANUAL. It's read-only otherwise, but useful for spotting a problem that keeps recurring.

6.4 Settings overview

Route: Admin → Settings. A single page, organised into collapsible sections - expand only the ones you need.

- **Printing** - picking-note and shipping-label printer names (blank uses the PC default), label printer DPI (must match the physical thermal printer - 203 or 300), and the Print Agent URL (the small local service that turns a web print request into real printer output; without it, printing falls back to opening a PDF in a new tab).
- **Email** - the shared/fallback SMTP account used for anyone who hasn't set up their own under My Email.
- **DPD** - covered in full in Section 6.5, since it's the largest section on the page.

- **Despatch & Packing** - toggles for auto-sending the acknowledgement email and auto-printing the picking note on release, plus the global Packing Mode (Split vs. Serial - Section 3.4).
- **Returns (RMA)** - the standard return window in days (default 28) and the faulty/RTB warranty window in days (default 365), which drive the automatic window check shown on the public RMA form and RMA Detail screen.
- **Users** - the list of logins, with a Change Password action per user and a form to add a new one. There's currently no admin/staff role distinction - any logged-in user can manage any other user's login.
- **My Email** - a per-user SMTP override, so acknowledgement/despatch emails a particular staff member sends go out under their own address rather than the shared one; anything left blank falls back to the shared Email settings.
- **Customisation** - per-user colour pickers for each order status, controlling the row-tint on Sales Activity (Section 1.1).
- **Bulk Stock Import** - a card linking through to the Stock Import tool (Section 3.8).
- **Danger Zone** - only visible when test-data reset is switched on for this environment. "Reset Test Data" permanently clears stock items, movements, inventory, expected cartons, goods-in sessions and purchase orders (typing RESET confirms), leaving products, locations, suppliers, sales orders, bug reports and API keys untouched. "Clear Demo Products" removes the pre-seeded example products and their demo orders (typing CLEAR confirms), for starting with a clean catalogue.

[SCREENSHOT PLACEHOLDER — Settings page with a couple of sections expanded]

6.5 DPD settings, in detail

DPD is BNS's courier integration, and its settings section is the largest on the page because it covers three related things: authenticating to DPD, BNS's own sender details (used both for collection and as the customs "exporter"), and customs handling for shipments like Ireland that need a full declaration.

- API key and secret, from DPD's developer portal (not the normal DPD account login), and a sandbox/live environment toggle.
- A preferred service code, used only when DPD actually offers it for that particular shipment, and a weight cap that stops the live service lookup tipping over into Freight/pallet-style quotes.
- A full sender/collection address block, including EORI and VAT numbers - this doubles as the customs "exporter" details on any shipment that needs a customs declaration.
- Customs section: a Goods Description (required whenever a shipment needs a declaration - e.g. Ireland) and a Currency.
- A toggle for DPD's chargeable Extended Liability cover.
- A toggle to print a placeholder sample label at despatch if a real DPD shipment couldn't be booked, so the warehouse still has something physical to work with rather than a stalled order.

[SCREENSHOT PLACEHOLDER — DPD settings section, expanded, showing the sender address block]

About this guide

This is a draft, generated to show the shape the guide can take - section structure, level of detail, and where screenshots will sit. It covers every screen in the system as of v0.092 (the release that added Support Tickets). As the system keeps changing, this guide should be kept in step with it; the next pass should add the real screenshots in place of the placeholder boxes throughout, once there's browser access to the live system to capture them from.